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In This CORNER

by Bill Hodge

ON A CLUB well-sprinkled with veterans from the major league diamonds, Manager Andy Cohen of the Indianapolis Indians believes he has a first baseman who is on his way up to the big tent.

He is Ron Jackson, a 6-7 native of Kalamazoo, Mich. who was whisked away from the college basketball courts a couple of years ago for a \$60,000 bonus.

Cohen and his Indianapolis club are in town this weekend for a four-game series with the Wichita Braves, before the Braves head west on Monday for another road trip.

And the veteran manager had much good to say about his first sacker.

"I believe Jackson is a real corner," Cohen was saying. "He is 6-7 and weighs 240 pounds, is surprisingly graceful around the bag, and has tremendous power. The only thing is that he doesn't hit as consistently as we'd like him to, but then if he did everything right he wouldn't be with us, he would be up in the majors."

In early play this season Jackson has been a streak hitter, going three-or-four one night and then going for the horse-collar the next night.

He can lay claim to a batting average of .330 through the Indians' last start, though, which indicates his slumps are getting further apart.

The big Indian first baseman was recruited from the campus of Western Michigan University where he was regarded highly as a basketball player.

But Western Michigan officials weren't as high on him for basketball as were the White Sox for their business, and so Jackson packed his grip.

COHEN ISN'T GOING onto any limbs right now in comparing Jackson with the other first basemen in the Association. But he will speak up in this regard for Ted Beard, the former Pittsburgh Pirate outfielder who plays a lot of centerfield for Indianapolis.

"There is no better centerfielder in the league," the Tribe manager said. "He has been doing a great job for us, both in centerfield and in hitting."

Beard, one of the few carryovers from the 1956 pennant-winning Indianapolis club, was hitting a healthy .340 as of Saturday morning.

COHEN SEES PITCHING as his only real problem right now.

"I'm keeping my fingers crossed about the pitching," he said.

Some pitching help already has been acquired for him though and more might be on the way.

Lefthander Roy Tinney who will pitch Saturday night in one of the games of the Wichita-Indianapolis doubleheader, was optioned for the season to Indianapolis by the Boston Red Sox.

The Red Sox had Tinney at San Francisco in the Pacific Coast League for awhile.

But then Red Sox General Manager Joe Cronin, an old pal of Indianapolis club president Donnie Bush, moved him to Indianapolis on option.

Tinney beat Wichita in his only start in the Association when the clubs got together last weekend in Indianapolis.

COHEN HIMSELF has been a popular figure with Wichita baseball fans who first became acquainted with him in the early 1950's as the manager of Western League pennant-winning Denver Bears teams.

Cohen went from Denver to New Orleans of the double-A Southern Association where his Pittsburgh Pirate-supplied clubs finished seventh and fifth the last two seasons.

He was a welcome sight to those who had known him before when he came back to Wichita Friday in his new job.

Lots of persons around the grandstands in Wichita would like to see Andy Cohen and his young first baseman and his veteran outfielder finish second in the Association this season.

Their wishes for first-place are too obvious to mention.


